LeaveWell

Exit Assessment

A structured analysis of your financial runway, decision readiness, and recommended next steps for a career transition.

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Generated March 25, 2026

1. Your Numbers

These figures are based on your reported savings, expenses, income, and severance. They assume no additional income after leaving and no change to your current spending.

16.3 months

Your runway if you left today

Current liquid savings	**$68,000**
Severance (added to savings)	**$17,000**
Total available	**$85,000**
Monthly burn rate	**$5,200/mo**
Monthly burn rate (with 25% cuts)	**$3,900/mo**
Runway (current spending)	**16.3 months — Aug 2027**
Runway (with 25% spending cuts)	**21.8 months — Jan 2028**
Monthly savings rate if you stay	**$2,800/mo**
Safe quit date (12-month target)	**September 2026**

What this means: If you left your job today with no additional income, your savings and severance would cover approximately 16 months of living expenses at your current spending level. With moderate spending reductions (25%), you could extend that to nearly 22 months. If you continue working and saving at your current rate, you would reach a 12-month runway cushion by September 2026.

2. Your Readiness

PREPARE TO LEAVE

You have meaningful runway, but there are steps that would make your exit safer and stronger. The next 3-6 months are your preparation window.

LeaveWell uses three readiness tiers based on your financial position, risk factors, and practical preparedness:

Build More Runway — Less than 6 months of expenses saved, or significant unresolved financial risk. Leaving now would create unnecessary pressure.

> Prepare to Leave — 6-18 months of runway with manageable risk. You have room to move, but preparation would meaningfully improve your outcome.

Clear to Go — 18+ months of runway, low fixed obligations, and practical readiness factors in place. You can leave with confidence.

Why Prepare to Leave: Your 16-month runway is real and meaningful — you are not in financial danger. But you have a few risk factors (detailed below) that could compress your timeline if things don't go as planned. The smartest move is to use the next 3-6 months to strengthen your position while you still have income.

3. Your Pressure Profile

Pressure is what compresses your timeline, narrows your options, or forces worse decisions. Understanding where your pressure is coming from — and where you have room — is essential to making a clear-eyed exit decision.

What's working in your favor

+ **Strong savings base.** $85K total (savings + severance) is a serious cushion. You are not operating from scarcity.

+ **No dependents.** Your expenses are yours to control. You have flexibility to cut spending without affecting anyone else's wellbeing.

+ **Partner income.** $4,200/mo in partner income creates a meaningful safety net. Even if your runway calculation excludes it, knowing it exists changes your real risk profile.

+ **Moderate monthly burn.** $5,200/mo is manageable and has clear room for reduction. You are not locked into a high-overhead lifestyle.

+ **Active savings rate.** At $2,800/mo saved while working, every additional month you stay adds real runway.

What could create pressure

MODERATE **Healthcare costs may be underestimated.** You reported $620/mo for healthcare. Depending on your state, marketplace plans for a single individual can run $500-$900/mo. If you're currently on employer-sponsored insurance, verify actual marketplace pricing before making your decision.

MODERATE **No income replacement plan.** Your runway assumes zero income after leaving. Even modest freelance or consulting income ($1,500-2,000/mo) would extend your runway by 40-60%. Without a plan for this, you're running on savings alone.

ELEVATED **Fixed costs are 78% of monthly spending.** Rent, insurance, debt payments, and subscriptions make up the bulk of your expenses. This means your ability to meaningfully cut spending in a crisis is limited. The 25% reduction scenario assumes cuts that may be harder to execute than they appear.

MODERATE **Student loan payments ($450/mo) are non-negotiable.** This is a fixed drain that persists regardless of employment status. Factor this into any extended-runway scenarios.

Pressure Summary: Your financial pressure is low-to-moderate. You have real cushion and real flexibility. The primary risks are not catastrophic — they are compounding. Healthcare costs, fixed expenses, and the absence of income replacement could quietly erode your runway faster than the headline number suggests. The gap between your 16-month projection and your actual experience could be 2-4 months if you're not deliberate.

4. Scenario Comparison

The decision is rarely "leave or stay forever." It's usually about timing. Here's what each timeline buys you.

	Leave Now	Stay 3 Months	Stay 6 Months
Total savings at exit	**$85,000**	**$93,400**	**$101,800**
Runway (current spend)	16.3 mo	18.0 mo	19.6 mo
Runway (with 25% cuts)	21.8 mo	23.9 mo	26.1 mo
Runway exhaustion date	Aug 2027	Dec 2027	May 2028
Additional savings gained	—	**+$8,400**	**+$16,800**
Additional runway gained	—	+1.6 mo	+3.2 mo

The tradeoff: Each additional month you stay adds roughly $2,800 to your savings and 0.5 months to your runway. That's real, but it's not transformative. The question is whether the emotional cost of staying 3-6 more months is worth the financial cushion. If your burnout is accelerating, the productivity and decision quality you lose by staying may outweigh the savings you gain.

The honest read: You are already in a strong enough position to leave. Staying longer improves your margin but does not change the fundamental picture. If you are staying primarily out of fear rather than strategy, that is worth examining.

5. Blind Spots and Stress Test

These are factors that could affect your outcome but are often overlooked or underweighted when making an exit decision.

Tax implications of severance

Your $17,000 severance will be taxed as ordinary income. Depending on when you receive it and your total income for the year, your effective take-home may be $12,500-$14,000 after federal and state taxes. Your runway calculations above use the gross figure. Adjust downward by $3,000-$4,500 for a more conservative estimate.

COBRA vs. marketplace timing

If you leave, you'll have 60 days to elect COBRA coverage. COBRA premiums are typically 2-3x what you're paying now through your employer. Marketplace enrollment may have restrictions depending on your timing. Losing employer coverage qualifies you for a Special Enrollment Period. Plan the timing of your exit around this.

Identity and purpose gap

Financial runway is only one part of readiness. Many people who leave good-on-paper jobs experience a period of identity disruption — the loss of structure, status, and daily purpose can feel destabilizing even when the money is fine. Having a plan for what you're moving toward, not just what you're leaving, reduces this risk significantly.

Job search duration assumptions

The average job search for a professional at your level takes 3-6 months. If you are planning to take a sabbatical before searching, add that time to your search window. A 3-month break followed by a 5-month search means 8 months of zero income — which consumes roughly half your runway at current spending.

Lifestyle creep during sabbatical

People consistently underestimate how much they spend when they stop working. More free time often means more spending on meals, travel, hobbies, and incidental purchases. Budget for a 10-15% increase in discretionary spending during the first 3 months.

6. Your Next 30 Days

Based on your Prepare to Leave tier, here is a concrete action plan for the next 30 days. These are sequenced by priority, not by difficulty.

Week 1: Get Clear on the Real Numbers

• Log into your healthcare marketplace and price actual plans for your coverage needs. Replace the $620/mo estimate with a real quote.

• Calculate your actual severance take-home after taxes. Call your HR department or use a tax estimator to get the net figure.

• Review the last 3 months of spending and identify which expenses are truly fixed vs. cuttable. Be honest — most people overestimate their ability to cut.

Week 2: Build the Bridge

• Identify 2-3 realistic sources of income replacement (freelance, consulting, contract work) and estimate what you could earn in the first 6 months after leaving.

• Talk to one person who has made a similar transition. Not for advice — for calibration. Ask them what surprised them.

• Start a simple 'transition fund' that separates your runway savings from your daily spending. Having a clear pot of money you're drawing from reduces anxiety.

Week 3: Test the Decision

• Write down your exit date — even if it's tentative. Having a date on paper changes how you think about the decision. It shifts from abstract to real.

• Share your numbers with someone you trust (partner, close friend, financial advisor). Not to ask permission, but to say your plan out loud and see how it feels.

• Identify your biggest single fear about leaving. Write it down. Then write down what you would actually do if that fear came true. Most worst-case scenarios are survivable.

Week 4: Decide and Commit

• Revisit your numbers with real healthcare costs and net severance. Recalculate your actual runway.

• Choose a target exit date — or choose to stay with a specific new trigger condition (e.g., 'I'll leave when I hit $X in savings' or 'I'll reassess on [date]').

• If you're ready: give notice. If you're not: write down exactly what would need to be true for you to feel ready, and set a date to revisit.

7. Decision Confidence

Assessment confidence: Moderate-High

This assessment is based on the information you provided. Here is what we're confident about, and what would sharpen this analysis.

High confidence

- Your runway calculation is based on reported savings, severance, and monthly expenses. If those numbers are accurate, the 16-month figure is reliable.
- Your readiness tier (Prepare to Leave) is appropriate given your financial position and risk factors.
- The scenario comparison math is straightforward and accurate.

Lower confidence

- Healthcare cost estimates — these could swing your monthly burn by $200-400/mo, which adds up over a 12+ month runway.
- Income replacement assumptions — we assumed zero post-exit income. Any consulting, freelance, or part-time work would materially change the picture.
- Spending behavior during sabbatical — historical spending may not predict future spending during an unstructured period.

What would increase our confidence

- Actual marketplace healthcare quotes for your state and coverage level
- A realistic income replacement estimate for months 4-12 post-exit
- A line-by-line expense breakdown separating fixed from discretionary spending
- Your current employer's COBRA pricing for comparison

The bottom line: You are not in a crisis. You have real runway, real savings, and real options. The question is not whether you *can* leave — it's whether you've set yourself up to leave *well*. The next 30 days of preparation will make the difference between a leap of faith and a calculated transition. Use them.